90% FREE TIER | ALL LEVELS | 30 ROOMS

Confused Where to Start in TryHackMe?

Look no further. Hop into this guide and continue your hacking journey — step by step.

30 Free Rooms ◆ **7 Phases** ◆ **CEH Aligned**

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

→ Work through phases in order. Tick the checkbox once you complete the room.
→ Use your own Kali via OpenVPN (free) or THM AttackBox (1 hr/day free).
→ Spend 30 min trying solo before looking at any hints — the struggle IS the lesson.

WHY THIS GUIDE?

The CEH (Certified Ethical Hacker) exam tests 20 knowledge domains — from footprinting and scanning to cryptography, web app hacking, and malware analysis.

Most candidates study theory but arrive at the exam without ever having run a real Nmap scan, intercepted a live HTTP request, or cracked a hash in a terminal.

TryHackMe fixes that. It puts you inside a live vulnerable environment, guided by tasks that mirror exactly what CEH tests — in the order CEH tests them.

This guide maps 30 hand-picked FREE TryHackMe rooms directly to CEH domains, sequenced from zero to exam-ready across 7 progressive phases.

CEH DOMAINS COVERED IN THIS GUIDE

- 01 Footprinting & Reconnaissance
- 02 Scanning Networks
- 03 System Hacking
- 04 Web Application Hacking
- 05 SQL Injection
- 06 Password Cracking
- 07 Cryptography
- 08 Sniffing & Social Engineering
- 09 Vulnerability Analysis
- 10 Post-Exploitation & Privesc

WHO IS THIS FOR?

→ Students actively preparing for the CEH v13 exam
→ CS / MCA / BCA / BTECH students who want practical lab skills alongside theory
→ Developers transitioning into cybersecurity (full-stack background = advantage)
→ Anyone who opened TryHackMe and had no idea where to click first

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REALISTIC TIME TO COMPLETE

📅 ~2 weeks | Phases 1–3 | 1 hr/day
📅 ~2 weeks | Phases 4–5 | 1 hr/day
📅 ~2 weeks | Phases 6–7 | Weekends

◆ PHASE 1 ORIENTATION & SETUP

30–45 min total. Do this once to get comfortable with the THM interface.

01 Tutorial

⏱ 10 min 📌 Interface basics

Learn how rooms work — task flags, split screen, etc. Don't skip this one.

tryhackme.com/room/tutorial

02 Starting Out in Cyber Sec

⏱ 20 min 📌 CEH mindset

High-level overview of offensive vs defensive paths. Quick confidence booster.

tryhackme.com/room/startingoutincybersec

03 Introductory Researching

⏱ 30 min 📌 OSINT basics

Teaches you how to use exploit databases and research techniques — essential hacker skill.

tryhackme.com/room/introtoresearch

◈ PHASE 2 LINUX & NETWORKING CORE

Linux coursework helps here, but the attack context is totally different from academic learning.

04 Linux Fundamentals Part 1

⏱ 1 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

Commands, filesystem, basic navigation. Foundational for every machine you'll ever hack.

tryhackme.com/room/linuxfundamentalspart1

05 Linux Fundamentals Part 2

⏱ 1 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

File permissions, find, grep, processes. Directly maps to CEH system hacking domain.

tryhackme.com/room/linuxfundamentalspart2

06 Linux Fundamentals Part 3

⏱ 1 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

Cron jobs, package managers, services. Solidifies shell scripting instincts.

tryhackme.com/room/linuxfundamentalspart3

07 What is Networking?

⏱ 45 min 📌 CEH: Footprinting

IP, MAC, core protocols. Locks in attack-context networking terminology.

tryhackme.com/room/whatisnetworking

08 Intro to LAN

⏱ 45 min 📌 CEH: Footprinting

Topologies, ARP, DHCP. Builds solid scanning intuition for network reconnaissance.

tryhackme.com/room/introtolan

09 OSI Model

⏱ 30 min 📌 CEH: Sniffing

CEH exam questions come from every OSI layer. Know this cold before the exam.

tryhackme.com/room/osimodelzi

10 DNS in Detail

⏱ 45 min 📌 CEH: Footprinting

Record types, zone transfers — directly tested in CEH and used in real recon.

tryhackme.com/room/dnsindetail

11 HTTP in Detail

⏱ 45 min 📌 CEH: Web App Hacking

Methods, status codes, cookies, headers. Attack framing is different from dev perspective.

tryhackme.com/room/httpindetail

◉ PHASE 3 RECONNAISSANCE & SCANNING

CEH's biggest domains. Nmap alone accounts for 3-5 exam questions. Do not rush these rooms.

12 Nmap

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: Scanning Networks

The most important room for CEH. Learn every flag: -sS, -sV, -O, -p, -A. Heavily tested.

tryhackme.com/room/furthernmap

13 Nmap Live Host Discovery

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: Scanning

ARP, ICMP, TCP scanning for host discovery. Core enumeration skill for every engagement.

tryhackme.com/room/nmap01

14 Passive Reconnaissance

⏱ 1 hr 📌 CEH: Footprinting

WHOIS, nslookup, dig. The legal recon toolkit. CEH has a whole domain dedicated to this.

tryhackme.com/room/passiverecon

15 Active Reconnaissance

⏱ 1 hr 📌 CEH: Footprinting

Traceroute, ping, Telnet, nc probing. Hands-on complement to passive recon.

tryhackme.com/room/activerecon

16 Content Discovery

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: Web App Hacking

Gobuster, ffuf, directory brute-forcing. You'll use this on every single web machine.

tryhackme.com/room/contentdiscovery

◎ PHASE 4 WEB APPLICATION HACKING

Full-stack dev background is a massive advantage here. You understand WHY these vulns exist.

17 How Websites Work

⏱ 45 min 📌 CEH: Web App Hacking

Web dev background? Skim in 20 mins. CEH frames familiar concepts from an attack perspective.

tryhackme.com/room/howwebsiteswork

18 OWASP Top 10 — 2021

⏱ 3-4 hr 📌 CEH: Web App Hacking

The single most important web room. Each task = one OWASP category with a live lab. Go slow.

tryhackme.com/room/owasptop102021

19 Burp Suite: The Basics

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: Web App Hacking

CEH expects you to know Burp Suite. Intercepting, repeater, intruder — do the full room.

tryhackme.com/room/burpsuitebasics

20 SQL Injection

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: SQL Injection

You've built SQL queries — now exploit them. Dev background = faster pattern recognition.

tryhackme.com/room/sqlinjectionlm

21 Cross-site Scripting

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: Web App Hacking

Reflected, stored, DOM-based XSS. CEH theory and practical exploit labs in one room.

tryhackme.com/room/axss

22 File Inclusion

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: Web App Hacking

LFI/RFI vulnerabilities. Classic web attack class. Backend knowledge makes this click fast.

tryhackme.com/room/fileinc

🔴 PHASE 5 EXPLOITATION & POST-EXPLOITATION

Core CEH offensive domains. Metasploit is explicitly tested in the exam — know every command.

23 Metasploit: Introduction

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

msfconsole, search, use, set, run. CEH tests Metasploit directly — learn every command.

tryhackme.com/room/metasploitintro

24 Metasploit: Exploitation

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

Using exploits against real targets. Full practical Metasploit workflow end to end.

tryhackme.com/room/metasploitexploitation

25 Metasploit: Meterpreter

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

Post-exploitation — hashdump, shell, sysinfo, privilege escalation. All CEH-tested.

tryhackme.com/room/meterpreter

26 Hydra

⏱ 1 hr 📌 CEH: Password Cracking

Brute-force SSH, FTP, HTTP logins. Learn the flags — wordlists, threads, target syntax.

tryhackme.com/room/hydra

27 John the Ripper

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: Cryptography

Hash cracking with wordlists and rules. CEH cryptography domain is tested heavily.

tryhackme.com/room/johntheripper0

28 Encryption — Crypto 101

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: Cryptography

RSA, AES, hashing theory. The foundation you need for CEH cryptography questions.

tryhackme.com/room/encryptioncrypto101

◐ PHASE 6 PRACTICE MACHINES (BEGINNER)

Apply everything on real vulnerable machines. No guidance — just you and the target.

29 Pickle Rick

⏱ 1-2 hr 📌 Full pentest workflow

Web + Linux combo CTF-style room. Great confidence builder — do this first.

tryhackme.com/room/picklerick

30 Basic Pentesting

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: Full cycle

Enumeration -> exploitation -> privilege escalation on a real box. The clearest workflow.

tryhackme.com/room/basicpentestingjt

31 Ignite

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: Web App + System

Exploit a CMS vulnerability, get a shell, escalate privileges. Clean beginner machine.

tryhackme.com/room/ignite

32 Bounty Hacker

⏱ 1.5 hr 📌 CEH: Recon + Exploitation

FTP recon -> SSH brute force -> privilege escalation. A classic attack chain.

tryhackme.com/room/cowboyhacker

33 RootMe

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: Web App + Privesc

File upload bypass -> reverse shell -> SUID privesc. Beloved beginner machine. Take notes.

tryhackme.com/room/rrootme

◑ PHASE 7 INTERMEDIATE PRACTICE MACHINES

Post-CEH territory. Independent enumeration required. HTB-level skills start building here.

34 Blue

⏱ 2-3 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

MS17-010 (EternalBlue) exploit on Windows. A legendary vulnerability every pentester must know.

tryhackme.com/room/blue

35 Ice

⏱ 2-3 hr 📌 CEH: System Hacking

Icecast exploit -> Windows enumeration -> Meterpreter post-exploitation. Great Windows box.

tryhackme.com/room/ice

36 Crack the Hash

⏱ 2 hr 📌 CEH: Cryptography

Multi-format hash identification and cracking. Sharpens your John/Hashcat workflow.

tryhackme.com/room/crackthehash

37 Advent of Cyber (Archive)

⏱ Ongoing 📌 All CEH domains

25 daily beginner challenges per year. Free archives year-round. Best free THM content.

tryhackme.com/room/adventofcyber4

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*****A Note Before You Go This guide is completely my personal suggestion. These 30 rooms are what I found most useful while preparing for CEH. You are absolutely free to explore different paths, alternative platforms, or build your own roadmap as per your learning style. TryHackMe is not the only way. HackTheBox, PentesterLab, PortSwigger Web Academy, and VulnHub are all excellent alternatives worth exploring. Go with what works for you , the goal is to acquire the skill, not the platform. ▪ NOT SPONSORED BY TRYHACKME — This is 100% independent, unaffiliated content*****